

Spectrea Brand Guide

The complete brand system for Spectrea — a composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.



Tagline: We connect the dots. **Category:** Composable knowledge platform. **Pronunciation:** /spek-
TREE-uh/ (from Latin *spectra* — the full range or spectrum, with a second reading: *revealing*).

Strategic claim: Spectrea is the spectrum of clarity. Everything you know, in one living view — alive with possibility, yours to keep. See it whole. Trust what you see. Build on what you find.

1. Brand Foundation

Why we exist

We live in an information age that's paradoxically making us less informed — more data, less truth; more tools, fewer insights; more noise, less action. Spectrea exists to close the gap between having information, truly understanding it, and being able to build on it.

Mission

To make knowledge trustworthy, connected, and actionable — empowering people to build on what came before, so that every insight becomes the foundation for what comes next.

Vision

A world where anyone can see the full spectrum of what's known, trust what they see, and build on it — where understanding compounds across every boundary that used to contain it.

Positioning

- **For:** Anyone who works with knowledge.
- **Category:** Composable knowledge platform.
- **Promise:** Turns scattered information into compounding intelligence.
- **Tactical:** For anyone who works with knowledge, Spectrea is the composable knowledge platform that turns scattered information into compounding intelligence — unlike fragmented point solutions that silo your knowledge and hide their reasoning.

Messaging hierarchy

Primary theme is **Connection** — the headline “We connect the dots” and the idea that scattered knowledge becomes one living view. Three supporting themes:

1. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — “Intelligence you can trust.” Everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable.
2. **Compounding Intelligence** — “It gets smarter with every interaction.” Your second year is incomparably better than your first.
3. **Composability** — “Build exactly what you need.” Simple, combinable parts assembled into any solution.

Archetypes — tri-domain split

Spectrea splits its archetype across three surface domains. The voice and emotional register shift with the archetype that owns each surface; the visual aesthetic (spectrum + graph + Warm Blend + modern sans) stays consistent across all three.

Archetype	Owns	The feeling it creates
The Magician	Marketing surfaces (landing pages, launch video, social, blog headers)	The moment of seeing what was hidden. The thrill of pattern emerging from chaos.
The Sage	Trust surfaces (settings, errors, documentation, security pages)	Authority through clarity. The calm of being able to see exactly how something is true.
The Creator	Product surfaces (composition, editor, workflows)	The joy of making. Building something that’s yours.

Personality (five traits with guardrails)

- **Warm** — respects the person behind every interaction. *Guardrail: not soft — trust users to be capable.*
- **Perceptive** — sees patterns others miss; surfaces connections, then steps back. *Guardrail: not presumptuous — suggests, never dictates.*
- **Grounded** — powerful but never pretentious; substance over style. *Guardrail: not boring — substance needs spark.*
- **Adaptive** — meets you where you are; same system, different depths. *Guardrail: not shapeless — Spectrea has a point of view.*
- **Rigorous** — discipline that serves clarity. The system is prescriptive on purpose — fixed primitives, fixed palette, fixed motion language — so the brand reads recognisably across every surface. *Guardrail: not rigid — discipline serves meaning, not dogma.*

Emotional core

Empowerment + Clarity. Feeling more capable because Spectrea helped you see clearly and choose wisely. Like putting on glasses — everything that was blurry snaps into focus.

Visual metaphor

Living Network + Prism. The living network is Spectrea's central visual idea — a web of connections that grows denser and more alive with every interaction. The prism is the etymology echo — what enters as a single stream comes out as the full spectrum, organised and visible. The network is what the brand *feels like*; the prism is where the name *comes from*.

Aesthetic direction

Warm + Intelligent. Like a brilliant mentor — approachable yet deep. Rich colours, inviting spacing, feels human. References: Notion, Stripe. Tradeoff: **power over polish** — capability is sacred; elegance is valued but never at the cost of depth.

Values

1. **Human-First** — Spectrea serves people, not the other way around. AI assists understanding; it never replaces judgment.
2. **Trustworthy Intelligence** — everything you see is transparent; every action is reviewable; every connection can be followed back.
3. **Compounding Intelligence** — the more you use it, the more it gives back.
4. **Composable by Nature** — build solutions that fit your world; don't reshape your world to fit a tool.
5. **Accessible Power** — deep capability that meets you where you are. Floor high, ceiling infinite.

Anti-values (what Spectrea never does)

- Never replaces human judgment.
- Never leaves anyone behind.
- Never complex or bloated — if it needs a consultant, we failed.
- Never a black box — you can always ask "why?" and get an answer.

2. Voice & Tone

Voice formula

Clarity of explanation + experiential momentum. Tech earns its place by showing its work.

The formula applies on every surface. Tech doesn't earn its place by impressing or by sleight-of-hand; it earns it by *showing its work* — pointing to the reasoning, the evidence, the source. Confidence comes from being able to see how the answer was reached, not from being told to trust it.

One voice, three archetypes by surface

The voice formula stays the same; the *emotional register* shifts with the archetype that owns each surface:

- **Magician on marketing** — leads with discovery, surprise, the moment of seeing connections that were always there.
- **Sage on trust surfaces** — leads with verification, sources, inspection. Anywhere users go to confirm, review, or understand: settings, errors, audit views, docs, security pages.
- **Creator on product** — leads with agency, composition, building. The graph editor, primitives, workflows.

Tone spectrum

Context	Tone	Example
Marketing copy	Evocative, confident	"Every connection you never noticed. Surfaced."
Product UI	Clear, concise, warm	"3 new connections discovered — review them?"
Error messages	Specific, helpful, never blaming	"This file type isn't supported yet. Try PDF, DOCX, or MD."
Onboarding	Encouraging, low-friction	"Start with one document. The rest will compound."
Technical docs	Precise, well-structured	"The graph grows $O(n \cdot \log n)$ with document count when using the default indexer."

Vocabulary — twelve privileged words

The twelve brand-evocative words that should appear disproportionately often in copy. Each builds the *feeling* of Spectrea — clarity, aliveness, ownership, the act of seeing — without requiring the reader to know what the product does.

Privileged words: spectrum, clarity, whole, see, reveal, illuminate, surface, connect, compose, compound, alive, transparent.

Generic B2B SaaS words (insights, intelligence, transform, empower, unlock, enable, build, evolve, grow, deepen, expand) are still allowed but not privileged — they don't make Spectrea sound like Spectrea. Product-specific words (provenance, traceable, auditable, attributed,

sourced) are also allowed and useful when describing what the product actually does — they just don't do brand voice work.

Words we never use: AI-powered (overused), next-gen, state-of-the-art, world-class, breakthrough, unprecedented, game-changer, revolutionary.

3. Naming

- **Spelling:** Spectrea (capital S, no space).
- **Pronunciation:** /spek-TREE-uh/ — emphasis on the second syllable.
- **Etymology — dual reading:** From *spectra* (Latin: the full range or spectrum). The name does double duty:
 - **Reading 1 — Spectrum:** the full range. The complete view. The whole picture, all in one place.
 - **Reading 2 — Revealing:** bringing what was hidden into clear view. The shift from blur to focus.
 - Together: *the spectrum of clarity* — and the action behind the tagline "We connect the dots."
- **Never:** "SpectreAI", "Spectrea AI" (lead), "spectra" (missing e).

Feature naming convention

Apple-style: Title-case Proper Nouns without brand prefix. Each first-class feature stands on its own; the platform context (Spectrea) is implicit.

Feature	Canonical name
The knowledge graph	Knowledge Graph
Claims surface	Claims View (or Claims)
Observation records	Observations
Source records	Sources
AI assistant	Assistant
Multi-perspective view	Spectrum View
AI-surfaced suggestions	Suggestions
Provenance trails	Traces

Three rules:

1. **Default:** Title-case Proper Noun for first-class features. *Knowledge Graph*, not *knowledge graph*.
2. **Brand-prefix:** reserved for distinct branded surfaces — separately-paid tiers, developer surfaces, installable companions. Only after deliberate review (a hypothetical *Spectrea Studio* would qualify).
3. **In running prose:** lowercase generic nouns are acceptable when natural ("the assistant suggested"). Canonical name in marketing headers, documentation cross-references, and product UI labels.

4. Logo System



Anatomy

The logo has three parts:

1. **Mark** — the "connecting the dots" S-curve. 10 dots along a cubic Bézier path, with the final three visually trailing. Spectrum-gradient stroke connecting the first seven. The mark also reads as the leading `S` glyph in the lockup.
2. **Wordmark** — Albert Sans Semibold 600, 0.02em letter-spacing. Inside the canonical `Logotype` / `LogotypeGradient` components, the S mark replaces the leading `S` and only the tail `pectrea` is typeset in lowercase — a stylistic treatment, not the typed name. In every other context (manual lockups like the sidebar, descriptor variants, prose, headings, URLs-excepted), use the sentence-case `Spectrea` — the mark sits beside it as a companion glyph rather than a letter substitute.
3. **Lockup** — S mark + lowercase wordmark.

Construction

- **Dots:** 10 dots, radius 3.5. Grey (`#A3A3A3`) in the primary treatment.
- **Stroke:** width 8, round linecap. Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) in the static mark and in the gradient lockup's mark.
- **Trailing dots:** the last 3 dots are left visually unconnected — the "about to connect" moment.

- **Container:** 64×64 construction viewBox. Circle container when needed at small sizes; never a squircle.

The two-forms rule (lockup)

The lockup has **exactly two forms** — no third:

1. **Gradient lockup** — `LogotypeGradient` component. S mark carries the two-tone Cool Duet (Cobalt `#4271DF` → Teal `#00B6A0`) on the stroke only; all dots stay grey. The wordmark is monotone — Ink on light, White on dark — following the `colorMode` prop.
2. **Mono lockup** — `Logotype` component. Everything renders in a single `ink` / `white` / `grey` colour.

The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of two overlapping curved lines, one blue and one teal, with two small grey dots below it. To the right of the mark, the word 'spectrea' is written in a lowercase, sans-serif font.The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of two overlapping curved lines, one dark grey and one light grey, with two small grey dots below it. To the right of the mark, the word 'spectrea' is written in a lowercase, sans-serif font.The logo features a stylized 'S' mark composed of two overlapping curved lines, one white and one light grey, with two small grey dots below it. To the right of the mark, the word 'spectrea' is written in a lowercase, sans-serif font, all contained within a solid black rectangular background.

The gradient lives in the mark only. No gradient-filled wordmark, no full-spectrum lockup — the wordmark is always solid so it stays legible at every size. Duets (Balanced / Warm) belong to the static mark only; they are not lockup options.

Mark colour modes

- `'color'` — full spectrum (Cobalt → Teal → Amber). Default for `AnimatedLogo`. Used for hero moments.
- `'cool'` — Cool Duet (Cobalt → Teal). Default for `StaticLogo`. Primary static mark for everyday use.
- `'balanced'` — Balanced Duet (Teal → `#6FB884` at 65% → Amber). For product/ecosystem moments.
- `'warm'` — Warm Duet (Amber → Rose). For marketing attention.
- `'grey'` — Pewter. Watermarks only.
- `'white'` — Canvas `#FDFDFB`. Dark backgrounds.
- `'ink'` — Ink `#18181C`. Formal, co-branding, single-colour print.

Dot-colour rule

- **Mono mode** (`ink` / `white` / `grey`) → dots match the mark — not grey.
- **Gradient/duet mode** → dots are grey (`#A3A3A3`). This is the primary brand treatment.
- **Exception:** the intentional "Ink + Grey Dots" variant labelled *Quiet authority* — connection formed, spectrum dormant.

Variants (11 approved)

On light backgrounds:

1. Primary mark (Cool Duet, grey dots)
2. Primary lockup
3. Ink mark
4. Ink lockup
5. Grey mark (watermark only)

On dark backgrounds: 6. Primary on dark (Cool Duet + grey dots) 7. Primary lockup on dark 8. White mark 9. White lockup

Contained (below 48px): 10. Ink circle (white mark on ink fill) 11. White circle (ink mark on white fill)

Lockup arrangements (three)

1. **Gradient logotype** — `LogotypeGradient` . Preferred for brand/marketing.
2. **Horizontal with descriptor** — `StaticLogo` + sentence-case `Spectrea` wordmark + descriptor below. For nav, product headers, sub-brands. Descriptor styling: `gap-3` between mark and wordmark column, `text-xs` , uppercase, tracking-widest, Pewter (`#97979E`). Because this is a manual composition (not the canonical `Logotype` component), the mark sits beside the wordmark as a companion glyph — the S is not dropped, and the word is typed `Spectrea` exactly as in running prose.
3. **Stacked** — mark above wordmark. For title slides, centered compositions. Wordmark width $\leq$ mark width.

When to use which variant

Context	Variant	Why
Website header (light)	Logotype	Preferred horizontal treatment
Website header (dark)	Logotype (white)	White logotype on dark
Product sidebar / nav	#1 + descriptor	Primary mark with descriptor
Favicon (16–32px)	#10	Ink circle — high contrast small
App icon	#10	Bold, distinctive in app grids
Social avatar	#10	Circular crop on most platforms
Social cover image	#2 or #7	Full lockup, match cover background
Marketing hero	Logotype or stacked	Logotype inline; stacked centered
Co-branding	#3 or #4	Ink prevents colour competition
Legal / formal	#4	Ink lockup — authoritative, max contrast
Watermark	#5 at low opacity	Grey mark, subtle
Emboss / foil stamp	#3	Single-tone production

Clear space

Minimum clear space around the lockup = 0.5× the mark height. No other graphic element (text, border, background image) enters the clear-space box.

Misuse

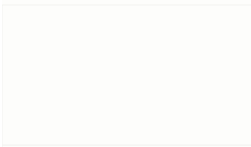
Never: stretch or distort · change colours (spectrum gradient is Cobalt → Teal → Amber; never substitute) · rotate · add drop shadows, glows, bevels · use only the stroke path without dots · use on low-contrast backgrounds (< 2.5:1) · change dot count (always exactly 10) · swap mark and wordmark positions · violate clear space · use a squircle container (always round) · colour the dots in the primary treatment · substitute the wordmark typeface.

5. Colour System

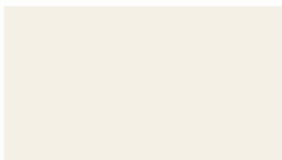
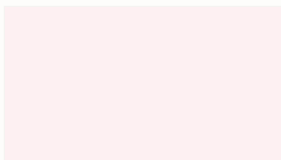
SPECTRUM ACCENTS

			
Cobalt #4271DF	Teal #00B6A0	Amber #E19000	Rose #F24260

WARM BLEND NEUTRALS

				
Canvas #FDFDFB	Cloud #F4F4F1	Pewter #97979E	Graphite #212226	Ink #18181C

BRIDGE TIER (TINTED WASHES)

			
Cobalt Wash #EDF0F8	Teal Mist #E6F5F3	Amber Stone #F5F0E6	Rose Blush #FDF0F2

Spectrum is the brand signature

The four-colour spectrum (Cobalt + Teal + Amber + Rose) is the brand's central visual claim — comparable to how Google's four colours signal Google or Microsoft's four squares signal Microsoft. In **marketing surfaces**, the spectrum is used confidently as the brand's identity: hero gradients, full-spectrum illustration moments, spectrum lockups, the lockup gradient as the signature mark treatment.

In **product UI**, the same four colours stay strictly *semantic* (Tier 3 framework below): Cobalt for action, Teal for success, Amber for attention, Rose for urgency. The discipline doesn't change; only the airtime does. Marketing spends budget on spectrum hero moments; product reserves it for meaning.

Warm Blend neutrals (applied system-wide)

A subtle warm tint layered under the spectrum — closes the gap between cold Tailwind grays and the warm accents. Luminance shift is <2% but cohesive as a system.

Role	Name	Hex	CSS var
Background	Canvas	#FDFDFB	--color-canvas
Elevated surface	Cloud	#F4F4F1	--color-cloud
Muted / secondary text	Pewter	#97979E	--color-pewter
Dark UI surface	Graphite	#212226	--color-graphite
Primary text / dark surface	Ink	#18181C	--color-ink

Spectrum accents (the four spectrum colours)

Role	Name	Hex	Meaning
Hero / primary	Cobalt	#4271DF	Intelligence, trust, focus. One primary action per section.
Positive / growth	Teal	#00B6A0	Success, growth, connected status.
Attention	Amber	#E19000	Warnings, pending, confidence.
Urgency / action	Rose	#F24260	Errors, destructive actions, critical alerts.

Hover/active states for each accent:

- Cobalt: base #4271DF , hover #3A63C4 , active #3255A7 .
- Teal: base #00B6A0 , hover #009E8A , active #008775 .
- Amber: base #E19000 , hover #C58200 , active #A86E00 .
- Rose: base #F24260 , hover #D63B55 , active #BA3249 .

Bridge tier (tinted washes)

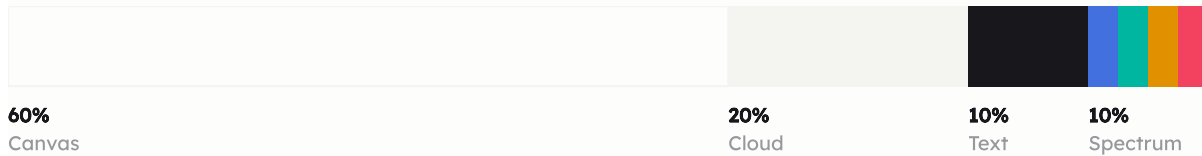
Tiered between the neutral canvas and the vivid accents — 5–10% saturation versions of each spectrum colour. Always carry semantic meaning; never decorative.

Name	Hex	Paired accent	Use
Cobalt Wash	#EDF0F8	Cobalt	Info alert background, selected row
Teal Mist	#E6F5F3	Teal	Success toast, positive trend card
Amber Stone	#F5F0E6	Amber	Warning alert, highlighted callout
Rose Blush	#FDF0F2	Rose	Error message, destructive confirmation

Colour ratio (the 60/20/10/10 rule)

- **60%** Canvas (page background)

- **20%** Cloud (elevated surfaces: cards, sidebars, dropdowns)
- **10%** Ink + Pewter (text and UI)
- **10%** Spectrum accents (semantic moments only)



Tiered colour framework

Every colour in Spectrea lives in one of three tiers:

1. **Tier 1 — Responsive (Cobalt).** Action-oriented elements — things that trigger an operation. Temporary and reactive: present during hover, focus, press, then settles. Primary buttons, links, CTAs, input focus, hovered icons.
2. **Tier 2 — Structural (Ink).** Persistent state and navigation. Active nav item, selected tab, toggled-on icon, current breadcrumb. Ink keeps the canvas calm while Cobalt stays reserved for action.
3. **Tier 3 — Semantic (spectrum + Pewter).** The system communicating status. Info (Cobalt), success (Teal), warning (Amber), error (Rose). Never decorative — every appearance carries meaning.

6. Gradients

Three gradients — don't conflate them.

Primary brand gradient (the default)

Cobalt → **Teal** → **Amber** at 135°, interpolated in **OKLCH** on modern browsers with a clean sRGB fallback. This is the everyday brand gradient — hero sections, accent bars, dividers, decorative strips, progress indicators.



Brand gradient

`linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000)` — sRGB fallback

Cross-browser CSS recipe

```
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
```

```

}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}

```

The `@supports` block is silently ignored by browsers that don't understand OKLCH (Chrome <111, Safari <16.2, Firefox <117) — they keep the sRGB base. Modern browsers apply the OKLCH override for a perceptually richer middle that avoids the muddy olive zone.

Lockup mark gradient (inside `LogotypeGradient` only)

Two-tone Cool Duet — the same gradient as the primary static mark. The wordmark stays monotone (Ink / White); only the mark carries colour.

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0

Implemented in SVG (`<linearGradient>`). **Never used as a general-purpose decorative gradient.**



Lockup mark gradient — `LogotypeGradient` only, Cool Duet

0% #4271DF → 100% #00B6A0 (wordmark stays monotone Ink / White)

Full spectrum with Rose (sparingly)

Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose at 135°. Use only for peak brand expression — landing-page heroes, launch moments. Reserving it keeps its impact.



Full spectrum with Rose — marketing only, use sparingly

#4271DF → #00B6A0 → #E19000 → #F24260

Two-colour duets (adjacent pairs only)

Must use **adjacent** spectrum pairs. Skip pairs (Cobalt → Amber direct, Teal → Rose, Cobalt → Rose) break the continuous-spectrum metaphor and are off-brand.

- **Cool Duet** — Cobalt → Teal. Intelligence + growth. The resting-state duet. Used by the static S mark and data/technical contexts.

- **Balanced Duet** — Teal → #6FB884 at 65% → Amber. *Must* include the #6FB884 intermediate; without it, teal and amber desaturate into muddy olive. For product/ecosystem moments.
- **Warm Duet** — Amber → Rose. Energy + urgency. Marketing, launches, attention.



Cool Duet — intelligence + growth

#4271DF → #00B6A0



Balanced Duet — must include #6FB884 bridge

#00B6A0 → #6FB884 (65%) → #E19000



Warm Duet — energy + urgency

#E19000 → #F24260

Gradient rules

- **Use for:** logo mark background, hero accent bars, marketing page headers, loading progress bars, slide deck title dividers, social media profile accents.
- **Never for:** buttons (use solid Cobalt), text colour, body backgrounds, borders, small icons or badges, repeated elements.

7. Typography

We connect the dots.

ALBERT SANS BOLD 700 · 32px · Display / Hero

Knowledge, connected.

ALBERT SANS SEMIBOLD 600 · 22px · H2 / Section heading

Every document you upload enriches your knowledge graph.

LEXEND REGULAR 400 · 16px · Body

`entity.type: "Financial Model" | confidence: 0.94`

JETBRAINS MONO REGULAR 400 · 13px · Code / Metadata

Type system (three typefaces)

Role	Family	Weights	Use
Headings	Albert Sans	600 (Semibold), 700 (Bold — logo wordmark, hero only)	Page titles, section headings, card titles, stat values
Body	Lexend	300, 400, 500	Body text, descriptions, form labels, nav items
Code / metadata	JetBrains Mono	400	Inline code, data values, entity types, provenance

Type scale

Display
Heading 1
Heading 2
Heading 3

Body Large — leading paragraphs

Body — default paragraphs

Body SM — secondary text

Caption — labels, timestamps

OVERLINE — SECTION LABELS

code · data values · 0.94

48px · line 1.1

36px · line 1.2

30px · line 1.25

24px · line 1.3

18px · line 1.6

16px · line 1.6

14px · line 1.5

12px · line 1.5

12px · 0.05em tracking

14px · mono

Size	Value	Line height	Weight	Use
Display	48 px	1.1	600	Hero headlines, landing-page titles
H1	36 px	1.2	600	Page titles
H2	30 px	1.25	600	Major section headings
H3	24 px	1.3	600	Sub-section headings, card titles
H4	20 px	1.4	600	Minor headings, dialog titles
H5	18 px	1.4	600	Sidebar section titles
Body LG	18 px	1.6	400	Lead paragraphs
Body	16 px	1.6	400	Default body text
Body SM	14 px	1.5	400	Secondary text, table cells, form inputs
Caption	12 px	1.5	500	Labels, timestamps, helper text
Overline	12 px	1.5	600	Section labels (uppercase + 0.05em tracking)

Responsive scale

Desktop (1024+) / Tablet (640–1023) / Mobile (<640):

- Display: 48 / 36 / 30
- H1: 36 / 30 / 24

- H2: 30 / 24 / 20
- H3: 24 / 20 / 18
- Body / Body SM: unchanged across breakpoints.

Accessibility

- Body text minimum: 16 px. Never lower for primary content.
- Contrast ratio minimum: 4.5:1. Ink on Canvas $\approx$ 17.6:1. Pewter on Canvas $\approx$ 3.1:1 (decorative only).
- Never rely on colour alone — pair colour coding with icons, patterns, or labels.
- Layout must not break at 200% browser text-zoom.

8. Iconography

Library: Tabler Icons (`react-icons/tb` — outline + filled from one library).

Specs:

- Style: outline by default; filled only for active/selected states.
- Stroke width: 2 px (Tabler default, consistent across all icons).
- Stroke caps/joins: round (matches the brand's warm personality).
- Grid: 24×24 px.
- Padding: 2 px inset — content stays within a 20 px live area.

Colour system (tiered):

- **Ink** (`#18181C`) — primary: nav, headings, actions.
- **Pewter** (`#97979E`) — secondary: helpers, disabled, muted.
- **Cobalt** (`#4271DF`) — active state, selected, links (hover responsive).
- **Cloud** (`#F4F4F1`) — on dark backgrounds.

Rule: never use spectrum accents (Teal, Amber, Rose) for decorative icons. Those colours are reserved for semantic meaning.

9. Illustration — the Dot System

Every Spectrea illustration assembles from **five primitives**: Dot, Curve, Cluster, Trail, Field. Brand palette only, on Canvas. The brand mark itself is this system at small scale; illustrations extend it at larger scale. Anything not assembled from these five atoms is off-brand.

The five atoms

1. **Dot** — filled circle in a brand colour. The fundamental unit. A point of attention. Stand it for whatever the illustration needs it to stand for.
2. **Curve** — a soft Bézier line that connects. The relationship between two things. Same flowing feel as the Spectrea mark.
3. **Cluster** — a group of 3–8 dots in proximity. Things that belong together. A whole made of parts.
4. **Trail** — a sequence of dots in directional order, opacity or size increasing from earliest (faint) to latest (full). Movement through time. The path from then to now.
5. **Field** — a soft tinted radial or linear wash using one bridge tone (Cobalt Wash `#EDF0F8` , Teal Mist `#E6F5F3` , Amber Stone `#F5F0E6` , or Rose Blush `#FDF0F2`). Atmospheric depth — the air around the subject, never the subject itself.

The rule

Every brand illustration assembles from these five atoms only, in the brand palette, on Canvas or a Field. **Filled shapes only — no outlines, no strokes on dots, no drop shadows, no glows, no textures.** Curves are the only stroked elements (thin, soft, Pewter or spectrum).

Specialisations

The Dot System is the universal vocabulary; two specialisations apply it to specific surfaces:

- **Geometric specialisation** (icons, diagrams, product UI). Circles, rectangles, triangles, arcs, lines. Flat fills from the brand palette. The geometric primitives reduce to the same five-atom DNA — circles are dots; rectangles are oriented dots; triangles are arrows. Used for app UI, iconography, technical diagrams, developer documentation, changelogs, status pages.
- **Bauhaus figure specialisation** (human / team imagery). Each person = head dot + soft rounded torso shape, in one brand colour. Multiple people = a cluster of these figures, optionally connected by Pewter curves (their "shared graph"). Used for about pages, customer stories, team imagery.

Production workflow

1. Generate with a free + commercial-safe AI tool (Gemini, Bing Image Creator / DALL-E 3, Adobe Firefly, or Stable Diffusion locally) using the **Dot System v2 prompt** at `docs/illustration-prompt.md`
2. Vectorise the raster output with **Inkscape** (Path → Trace Bitmap → Multiple scans → Colors)
3. Drop the SVG into `/public/illustrations/` , or paste markup into a React component
4. Snap fills to exact Spectrea hex codes, namespace IDs, clean up excess paths
5. **Reject any output that introduces shapes outside the five atoms.** Triangles, abstract blobs, wireframes, line art, mascots — all off-brand. Regenerate.

Prompt template: versioned at `docs/illustration-prompt.md` in the repo (internal, not served publicly). Keep that file as the single source of truth — edit there, not here.

What the Dot System never does

- Outlines, strokes on dots, borders, line art
- Photorealism, 3D rendering, isometric projection
- Drop shadows, glows, lens flares
- Heavy textures, noise, grain, hatching
- Off-brand colours (neon, magenta, cyan, bright yellow, pastel pink, purple, lavender, bright green)
- Mascot characters, anthropomorphic objects
- Detailed facial features (use the Bauhaus distillation when figures are needed)
- Overcrowded scenes

One register everywhere

Marketing surfaces and product surfaces share the same illustration vocabulary — the Dot System. The variation is *how dense* and *how much hero treatment*, not *what kind of brand*. Marketing is product-with-room-to-breathe; product is marketing-with-functional-density. Same visual world.

10. Motion

Philosophy

Purposeful, subtle, natural — and alive. Every animation answers “what does this help the user understand?” — if the answer is “nothing,” remove it. Most interactive motion stays restrained (150–300ms hovers, focus, state changes). Three signature primitives below carry the brand’s “alive, growing, compounding” claim — used purposefully, not decoratively.

Durations

- 100 ms — micro (hover tints, colour shifts)
- 150 ms — standard (UI transitions, dropdowns)
- 200 ms — comfortable (modals, slide-overs)
- 300 ms — deliberate (page transitions, choreographed sequences)

Easing

- `ease-out` (`cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0.2, 1)`) — default for things entering or settling.

- `ease-in-out ( cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1) )` — for back-and-forth movements, continuous animations.
- Never use linear (feels mechanical) or ease-in alone (feels like something is wrong).

Signature motion primitives (three)

Three brand-distinctive motion primitives. Used at specific moments only — not decoratively. Each owns one part of the *alive, growing, compounding* brand claim.

1. Node arrival (~400ms). Trigger: a new node enters the graph (extraction, AI suggestion, user action). Spec: scale from 0 with soft elastic settle (`cubic-bezier(0.34, 1.56, 0.64, 1)`), then a brief radial pulse in the node's spectrum colour. Used in the live graph view, marketing demo videos, and onboarding moments.

2. Edge formation (~300ms). Trigger: a relationship forms between two nodes. Spec: edge draws from source toward target with the spectrum gradient running along the line, then settles to its resting colour. Implemented via `stroke-dashoffset` animation on an SVG path with a linear gradient stroke. Used wherever the graph is shown live or recorded.

3. Spectrum shift (~600ms). Trigger: AI surfaces a connection / insight / claim. Spec: a thin gradient strip (4px tall, ~75% width of its container) traverses Cobalt → Teal → Amber → Rose with `background-position` animation across a 4× wide gradient, fading in at 15% and out at 85%. The brand's signal for "AI just acted" — without saying the word AI. Used sparingly: only when AI has *meaningfully* acted (surfaced an insight, made a connection, completed an extraction). Not on every API response.

Animated mark

The Spectrea mark animates on a 3-second loop: the spectrum stroke draws along the S curve, pauses, then dissolves to reveal the dots again. Always uses the **full spectrum** (Cobalt → Teal → Amber) — the "reveal" moment. Use for loading states, hero animations, and motion assets.

10b. Data Visualization

The product's hero UI is a knowledge graph. The graph IS the brand. That makes graph rendering a brand artefact — not a local engineering choice. The rules below ensure the same node, edge, and confidence vocabulary appears across product UI, marketing screenshots, blog diagrams, and brand-guide examples.

Node rendering

Category determines colour; size encodes one signal at a time.

Node type	Colour	When
Primary entity	Cobalt #4271DF	The things the user is reasoning about
Relationship rendered as node	Teal #00B6A0	When the relationship itself is first-class (meetings, agreements, transactions)
Uncertain / contested claim	Amber #E19000 (70% opacity)	Uses the <code>hedge_marker</code> convention
Context / background	Pewter #97979E	Less prominent supporting nodes

Density cap: **~80 nodes per view** before clustering kicks in.

Edge rendering

Stroke style encodes relationship category; stroke weight encodes confidence.

Stroke style	Meaning
Solid	Confirmed relationship with provenance
Dashed	Inferred relationship (AI- or rule-derived)
Dotted	Hypothetical or proposed relationship

Default stroke colour: **Pewter**. Spectrum colours appear only on emphasised edges (selected, hovered, AI-surfaced). Stroke weight: 1.5–2.5px. Higher confidence → thicker. Direction (arrow) only when meaningful; bidirectional relationships render without arrows.

Confidence encoding

Opacity 50–100% maps to confidence 0.5–1.0. Linear ramp. Anything below 50% confidence is hidden by default (user can opt to show). Combined with the `hedge_marker` field in tooltips ("estimated", "preliminary", "hedged", "hypothetical").

Never use colour shift for confidence — colour is reserved for category. Opacity is the unambiguous confidence channel.

Provenance trails

When the user asks "trace this claim back to its source," the chain renders as a **Trail** (Dot System atom #4) — a sequence of dots from earliest source (faint, small) to final claim (full opacity, full size). Dashes between dots indicate derivation rather than direct connection. Source nodes (originating documents / observations) get a subtle outline ring on hover. Animation: nodes light up sequentially from source to claim — see *Edge formation* signature motion primitive above.

Interactive states

State	Treatment
Default	Full opacity, category colour
Hover	Slight scale-up (×1.1), 85% opacity. Cursor change.
Focused	2px Ink stroke ring (keyboard focus)
Selected	Outer halo at 18% opacity, inner node unchanged

Animation timing: 150ms ease-out for hover, instant for selection.

Layout & density

- **Full graph view:** up to 80 nodes onscreen. Force-directed layout, pan and zoom enabled.
- **Cluster view:** when density exceeds 80, nodes group into clusters. Click a cluster to expand.
- **Focus view:** single entity centred, immediate neighbours visible. Used for "explore this entity" surfaces.
- **Background:** Canvas (#FDFDFB) in light mode; Ink (#18181C) in dark mode.
- **Empty state:** single Cobalt dot centred + ghost hint dots in distance (Pewter at 30% opacity). Room to grow built into the composition.

Cross-product consistency

The same node / edge / confidence rendering must appear in: product UI (GraphExplorer , BubbleNode , CompositionNode), marketing screenshots, blog post diagrams, brand-guide examples, documentation, and pitch decks. If a graph rendered anywhere else looks different from these rules, it's off-brand. Consistency across surfaces is what makes the graph recognisable as Spectrea — not just *a* graph.

11. Components

Buttons

- **Primary (Cobalt)** — the hero action. One per section. #4271DF , white text; hover #3A63C4 ; active #3255A7 .
- **Secondary** — supporting actions. Cloud (#F4F4F1) background, Ink text (light); Graphite tint background, Cloud text (dark).
- **Ghost** — tertiary actions. 2-px border, transparent background.
- **Destructive (Rose)** — irreversible actions. #F24260 , white text.
- **Confirm (Teal)** — verify, approve, connect. #00B6A0 , white text.

- **Caution (Amber)** — override, merge, proceed. #E19000 , white text.

Common specs: padding px-4 py-2 (default), radius 8 px (rounded-lg), font Lexend 500 , font-size 14 px .

Focus ring: Amber rgba(225, 144, 0, 0.7) (alpha-tinted #E19000), 2 px solid, 2 px offset (.btn-focus:focus-visible).

Forms

Input fields: 1 px border (Tailwind stone-200 ≈ Cloud-adjacent), 8 px radius, px-3 py-2 padding, 14 px Lexend. On focus: 2 px Cobalt border, no separate shadow ring. Placeholder colour: Pewter.

Cards

Container: 1 px border (Tailwind stone-200), 12 px radius (rounded-xl), 20 px padding (p-5), Canvas background. Elevated variant adds shadow-md (floating elements only). Cards sit on the Cloud surface — the Canvas-vs-Cloud contrast gives them "home."

Layout

- **Sidebar:** 256 px fixed width, collapsible on mobile.
- **Top bar:** 40-48 px height. Search + user menu.
- **Content area:** fluid, scrollable, Cloud (#F4F4F1) background.
- **Breakpoints:** mobile <640 px (1 column), tablet 640-1023 (2 cols), desktop 1024-1279 (3 cols), wide 1280+ (4 cols).
- **Base spacing unit:** 4 px. All spacing values are multiples of 4.

12. Communications

Voice in action

Every piece of written output — product copy, email, social, presentation slides — follows the same voice formula: clear, specific, warm. Technical language is welcomed when it earns its place ("graph architecture" is fine; "leveraging our graph-based RAG pipeline for vector embeddings" is not).

Email

- **Signature:** Logotype at fontSize=11 , colorMode="ink" , color="#212226" , followed by "We connect the dots."
- **Transactional header:** LogotypeGradient at fontSize=13 on Canvas.

- **Marketing header (dark):** LogotypeGradient at `fontSize=13` on Ink. No `wordmarkColor` override.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 16 px , Ink on Canvas.

Social media

- **Avatar:** gradient mark at 400×400 px (square, no crop).
- **Cover images:** brand gradient bar + tagline on Ink background (LinkedIn); gradient bar at bottom with tagline centered (Twitter/X).
- **Bio template:** "We connect the dots. Composable knowledge platform."
- **Quote card:** Ink background, Cloud text, h-1 brand gradient accent strip at bottom.
- **Stat card:** Ink background, 3 xl Cloud number, Pewter supporting text, gradient accent strip at bottom.

Presentations

- **Canvas slide background:** Canvas (`#FDFDFB`).
- **Ink slide background:** Ink (`#18181C`) — for divider / emphasis slides.
- **Title typography:** Albert Sans 600, 48 px.
- **Body typography:** Lexend 400, 24 px.
- **Accent strip:** brand gradient, 4 px tall, at the bottom of title slides.
- **Footer:** Logotype at `fontSize=9` , `colorMode="ink"` , `color="#97979E"` .

13. Governance

The simple test

If you need to ask "is this OK?" — it probably isn't. The logo should always look exactly like the approved versions on the Variations page. When in doubt, use the primary treatment (grey dots, Cool-Duet stroke) on Canvas — that's always correct.

Change process

1. **Propose** — document what you want to change and why.
2. **Review** — design lead + brand lead sign off.
3. **Version** — bump this guide and the related code.
4. **Communicate** — change log posted in `#brand` .

Owner

Brand lead owns this document. Updates live here; downstream consumers (Figma library, Tailwind config, PDF export) are regenerated from this as source of truth.

14. Resources

CSS tokens

```
:root {
  /* Spectrum */
  --color-brand: #4271DF;
  --color-brand-teal: #00B6A0;
  --color-brand-amber: #E19000;
  --color-brand-rose: #F24260;

  /* Warm Blend neutrals */
  --color-canvas: #FDFDFB;
  --color-cloud: #F4F4F1;
  --color-pewter: #97979E;
  --color-graphite: #212226;
  --color-ink: #18181C;

  /* Typography */
  --font-heading: 'Albert Sans', sans-serif;
  --font-body: 'Lexend', 'Inter', sans-serif;
  --font-mono: 'JetBrains Mono', monospace;

  /* Radii */
  --radius-lg: 8px;
  --radius-xl: 12px;
}

/* Brand gradient — OKLCH with sRGB fallback */
.brand-gradient {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
}
@supports (background: linear-gradient(in oklch, red, blue)) {
  .brand-gradient {
    background: linear-gradient(135deg in oklch, #4271DF, #00B6A0, #E19000);
  }
}
```

Icon library

Tabler Icons via `react-icons/tb` — outline and filled from one library. 2 px stroke, round caps/joins, 24×24 grid.

Fonts

All via Google Fonts:

- [Albert Sans](#) (weights 600, 700)
- [Lexend](#) (weights 300, 400, 500)
- [JetBrains Mono](#) (weight 400)

This document is the single source of truth for the Spectrea brand. The live web version at spectrea.com/brand contains interactive demos and the asset generator. If this document and the web guide ever disagree, this document wins.